

Students explain why plants need light to make food.

Audience: student

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Think about a plant whose leaves have been covered so no light can reach them. Plants use light to make their food, so a plant kept in the dark cannot make the food it needs. Light is required for food-making in plants.

explain

Leaves are like tiny food factories. To make sugar, a leaf needs three things: light, water, and carbon dioxide. Water comes up from the roots, and carbon dioxide comes in from the air through small openings in the leaf. Using the light it catches, the leaf combines water and carbon dioxide to make sugar. That sugar is the plant's food, which helps it grow. Without light, a leaf cannot make this food, which is why plants need light to grow and stay healthy.

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